ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

# Academic Integrity and Exam Rules: Pass Without Cheating

What misconduct looks like, why it is punished, and how to protect yourself

CAMPUS LIFE

## Campus Life

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

**Written for students, by students.**

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Study smarter. Ask better questions. Pass with understanding.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

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# Why this pack exists

Misconduct findings can end a programme faster than poor grades. This pack explains plagiarism, collusion, impersonation, exam-hall offences and the reasonable steps that protect you, including how to handle accidental similarity and how to study when you feel unprepared.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

## What you will be able to do

- Define plagiarism, collusion and fabrication with examples.
- Explain common exam-hall offences and their consequences.
- Protect yourself through correct citation and record keeping.
- Prepare adequately instead of relying on shortcuts.

## How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

## What misconduct includes

Integrity rules cover anything that gives an unfair academic advantage or misrepresents your work.

- Plagiarism: presenting someone else's words or ideas without attribution.
- Collusion: working with others on an individual assessment.
- Fabrication: inventing data, results or references.
- Contract cheating: submitting work written by another person or service.
- Impersonation: sitting an examination on behalf of another student.
- Exam offences: unauthorised materials, communicating during the paper, or refusing instructions from invigilators.

## Protecting yourself

Most accidental problems are avoided by good habits, not by knowing penalties.

- Cite as you write, not afterwards.
- Quote exactly with quotation marks and a page reference.
- Keep drafts and research notes to show the work is yours.
- Do not share assignment files with coursemates; share explanations instead.
- Follow the department's rules on collaborative work.
- If you are unsure whether help is allowed, ask before submitting.

> **AI tools**
> Check your department's policy first. If use is permitted, disclose it and verify every fact and citation yourself. If it is not permitted, do not use it - an acknowledgement does not convert a prohibited act into an allowed one.

## Consequences and second chances

Penalties range from mark deductions to expulsion, and they follow you.

- Procedures usually include a report, an investigation and a panel hearing.
- You are normally entitled to see the allegation and respond.
- Honesty during a hearing usually matters more than a defensive denial.
- A finding can affect scholarships, graduation and professional licensing.
- Failing a course is recoverable; a misconduct record can be permanent.
- Seek advice from the student affairs office or a staff adviser.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

## Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. Define plagiarism.

Answer: Presenting another person's words, ideas or data as your own without proper acknowledgement.

2. What is collusion?

Answer: Unauthorised collaboration on an assessment intended to be completed individually.

3. How should you handle accidental similarity?

Answer: Paraphrase properly, cite the source and, where required, discuss it with your lecturer before submission.

4. Why is honesty during a misconduct hearing important?

Answer: It affects the panel's assessment of your conduct and can lead to a proportionate outcome, while dishonesty compounds the finding.

5. What is the safest approach to AI tools in assignments?

Answer: Follow the department's written policy; if permitted, disclose the use and verify all content yourself.

## Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Read your university's academic integrity policy.
- [ ] Learn your department's rules on collaboration.
- [ ] Practise citing three sources correctly while drafting.
- [ ] Keep drafts and notes for every assignment.
- [ ] Check the policy on AI and other digital assistance.
- [ ] Know the procedure for responding to an allegation.
- [ ] Plan a revision schedule so shortcuts are unnecessary.

## Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

# Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

**Three ideas I can now explain without notes:**

**A question I still cannot answer:**

**For my lecturer or course rep:**

**Next revision action and date:**